

GLOBAL AI HACKATHON SERIES

Build Your Own AI Agent on Qwen Cloud

Compete for **\$70,000** in prizes across five tracks

Sponsor	Alibaba Cloud
Administrator	Devpost, Inc.
Submission Deadline	July 9, 2026 — 2:00 PM Pacific
Winners Announced	On or around August 7, 2026
Total Prize Pool	\$70,000+ in cash and cloud credits

[Comprehensive Hackathon Reference · July 2026](#)

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1 · Hackathon Overview & Timeline

The Global AI Hackathon Series with Qwen Cloud challenges developers, teams, and organizations worldwide to build intelligent AI Agents using Alibaba Cloud's Qwen model family. The hackathon spans five distinct tracks covering memory, video creation, multi-agent systems, business automation, and edge computing.

Key Fact: No purchase or payment is necessary to enter or win. Free Qwen Cloud credits of \$40 USD are available to all eligible participants.

Timeline at a Glance

Phase	Date	Details
Submission Opens	May 26, 2026 8:00 AM PT	Hackathon officially launches; registration and building begins
■ Submission Deadline	July 9, 2026 2:00 PM PT	All submissions must be finalized and submitted on Devpost
Judging Period	July 10 – July 31, 2026	Expert panels evaluate all qualifying submissions
Winners Announced	~August 7, 2026 2:00 PM PT	Results published on the Hackathon Website
Prize Delivery	Within 60 days of verification	After completion of winner affidavit and required forms

2 · Eligibility & How to Enter

Who Can Enter

The hackathon is open to a broad range of participants globally, with certain restrictions tied to trade sanctions and platform availability.

Eligible	Not Eligible
Individuals aged 18+ (age of majority in their region)	Residents of sanctioned/restricted jurisdictions
Teams of eligible individuals	Promotion Entity employees and immediate family
Organizations (corporations, nonprofits, LLCs, partnerships)	Judges or companies employing a judge
One individual may join multiple teams AND enter individually	Individuals where Qwen Cloud registration is unsupported

Step-by-Step Registration Process

Step 1	Visit qwencloud-hackathon.devpost.com and click 'Join Hackathon'.
Step 2	Create a free Devpost account or log in with an existing account.
Step 3	Obtain Qwen Cloud access: sign up at qwencloud.com to check your free quota, or request a \$40 hackathon voucher via the coupon form if not eligible for a free trial.
Step 4	Build your project using Qwen Cloud models and tools within at least one track.
Step 5	Complete all required Submission fields on the Devpost entry page before the deadline.
Step 6 (Optional)	Publish a blog or social post documenting your journey and link it in your submission for the Bonus Prize.

Credit Note: You are responsible for any fees exceeding the \$40 credit amount. Monitor your Qwen Cloud usage carefully during development and testing.

3 · The Five Tracks — Detailed Breakdown

All submissions must build a project using Qwen models available on Qwen Cloud and must fall within at least one of the following five tracks.

Track 1	MemoryAgent	\$7,000 cash + \$3,000 credits
Description	Build an Agent with persistent memory that autonomously accumulates experience, remembers user preferences, and makes increasingly accurate decisions across multi-turn, cross-session interactions.	
Key Focus Areas	• Efficient memory storage and retrieval mechanisms • Timely forgetting / expiration of outdated information • Recalling critical memories within limited context windows • Improving decision accuracy across sessions over time	
Difficulty	Medium — memory architecture is well-understood but nuanced to implement well	

Track 2	AI Showrunner	\$7,000 cash + \$3,000 credits
Description	Leverage video generation capabilities (Wan / HappyHorse) to build an Agent that autonomously handles the entire short drama creation pipeline — from scriptwriting and storyboarding to video generation and editing.	
Key Focus Areas	• Autonomous narrative and screenplay generation • Storyboard creation and multimodal orchestration • Video generation and editing pipeline management • Maximizing output quality under a limited token budget • Note: This track has the HIGHEST token allowance of all tracks	
Difficulty	High — requires multimodal pipeline orchestration; highest token budget compensates	

Track 3 Agent Society		\$7,000 cash + \$3,000 credits
Description	Design a multi-agent collaboration system where multiple Agents with distinct capabilities work together through task division, dialogue, and negotiation to accomplish complex tasks.	
Key Focus Areas	• Task decomposition and role assignment across agents • Disagreement resolution and execution conflict handling • Measurable efficiency gain over single-agent baselines • Inter-agent communication protocol design	
Difficulty	High — requires careful orchestration architecture and comparative benchmarking	
Track 4 Autopilot Agent		\$7,000 cash + \$3,000 credits
Description	Build an Agent that automates real-world business workflows end-to-end. Scenarios are open-ended — for example: customer inquiry emails to quote generation, system alerts to automated remediation, or resume screening to interview scheduling.	
Key Focus Areas	• Handling ambiguous and incomplete inputs gracefully • Invoking external tools and APIs as part of workflow • Human-in-the-loop checkpoints at critical decision points • Production-readiness — emphasis on real-world applicability over demos • Clean error handling and fallback strategies	
Difficulty	Medium — well-defined success criteria; rewards engineering rigor	
Track 5 EdgeAgent		\$7,000 cash + \$3,000 credits
Description	Build Qwen-powered physical devices — robots, IoT agents, smart hardware — that perceive via edge sensors, reason via cloud APIs/Skills, and act locally.	
Key Focus Areas	• Robust edge-cloud orchestration under bandwidth/latency constraints • Privacy-aware data handling at the edge • Graceful degradation in offline or weak-network scenarios • Physical sensor integration (camera, microphone, motion, etc.)	
Difficulty	Very High — requires physical hardware; most niche but least competition	

4 · Prizes & Awards

Grand Prizes — One Winner Per Track

Track	Cash Prize	Cloud Credits	Extras
Track 1: MemoryAgent	\$7,000	\$3,000	Blog feature + Swag bag
Track 2: AI Showrunner	\$7,000	\$3,000	Blog feature + Swag bag
Track 3: Agent Society	\$7,000	\$3,000	Blog feature
Track 4: Autopilot Agent	\$7,000	\$3,000	Blog feature + Swag bag
Track 5: EdgeAgent	\$7,000	\$3,000	Blog feature + Swag bag

Additional Prizes

Award	Cash	Credits	Number of Winners
Top 10 Honorable Mention Projects	\$500	\$500	10 winners
Top 10 Blog Post Award	\$500	\$500	10 winners

Important: A project can only win ONE grand prize and up to one blog post prize. If no eligible submissions exist for a prize category, that prize will not be awarded. Prizes are non-transferable and non-substitutable by winners.

5 · Judging Process & Scoring Criteria

Two-Stage Evaluation

All eligible submissions go through two sequential evaluation stages. Judging may utilize expert panels, peer review, and automated AI-driven analysis.

Stage One — Viability Gate (Pass/Fail)	Stage Two — Scored Evaluation
Projects must reasonably fit the hackathon theme and reasonably apply the required Qwen Cloud APIs/SDKs. This is a binary pass/fail screen applied to all submissions. Projects failing this stage are disqualified.	All submissions that pass Stage One are scored on four weighted criteria by a panel of judges selected by Alibaba Cloud. Judges may be employees or third parties and may change before or during the judging period.

Stage Two — Weighted Scoring Criteria

30%**Innovation & AI Creativity**

Sophisticated use of Qwen Cloud APIs (custom skills, MCP integrations). Algorithm and engineering innovation — novel solutions, custom components, and meaningful performance optimization.

30%**Technical Depth & Engineering**

Architecture quality: modularity, scalability, and error handling. Engineering excellence: clean code and non-trivial logic. Tech stack sophistication: advanced patterns and thoughtful technology adoption.

25%**Problem Value & Impact**

Real-world relevance: solves an authentic technical or business pain point. Scalability potential: can the project be productized or become an open-source community contribution?

15%**Presentation & Documentation**

Technical demo clarity: key logic is visualized effectively in the demo video. Clear documentation: architecture diagrams and project descriptions are well-written.

Tie-Breaking: Ties are broken by comparing the highest-weighted criterion first (Innovation & AI Creativity at 30%), then proceeding through the remaining criteria in order. If still tied, the judge panel votes on the tied submissions.

6 · Submission Requirements Checklist

Every submission must include all items below. Use this as your pre-submission checklist.

	Working Project A functional project built using Qwen Cloud models, falling within at least one track.	REQUIRED
	Public GitHub Repository All source code, assets, and setup instructions. Must be public with a detectable open-source license (MIT, Apache 2.0, etc.) visible in the About section.	REQUIRED
	Text Description A clear explanation of your project's features, functionality, and how it uses Qwen Cloud.	REQUIRED
	Proof of Alibaba Cloud Deployment A link to a code file in your repo demonstrating use of Alibaba Cloud services and APIs. The backend must run on Alibaba Cloud.	REQUIRED
	Architecture Diagram A visual diagram showing how Qwen Cloud connects to your backend, database, and frontend components.	REQUIRED
	Demo Video (≤ 3 minutes) Uploaded to YouTube, Vimeo, or Youku. Must show the project functioning. Judges are not required to watch beyond 3 minutes.	REQUIRED
	Track Selection Clearly identify which of the 5 tracks your submission targets.	REQUIRED
	Blog / Social Post URL A public post documenting your journey building with Qwen Cloud. Include the link in your submission for eligibility for a \$500 Blog Post Prize.	OPTIONAL (Bonus Prize)

Language Requirement: All submission materials must be in English or accompanied by a full English translation of the video, text description, and testing instructions.

7 · Platform & Tools — Qwen Cloud

Qwen Cloud is Alibaba Cloud's developer platform for the Qwen model family. All projects must use Qwen models available on Qwen Cloud as their AI backbone.

Key Qwen Cloud Capabilities

Capability	Description	Primary Track
Qwen Chat Models	Large language models for reasoning, code generation, and dialogue	All tracks
MCP Integrations	Model Context Protocol for connecting agents to external tools and services	Track 4, Track 3
Wan / HappyHorse	Video generation models for autonomous video creation pipelines	Track 2
Custom Skills	Extendable function-calling capabilities for specialized domain tasks	All tracks
Cloud APIs	ECS, Function Compute, and other Alibaba Cloud services for deployment	All tracks (deployment)
Edge SDK	Lightweight Qwen inference for IoT and physical device integration	Track 5

Getting Started with Qwen Cloud

1. Sign up at qwencloud.com — check free quota at home.qwencloud.com/benefits
2. If not eligible for free trial, use the coupon form to request \$40 in hackathon voucher credits
3. Access Qwen model APIs via the Qwen Cloud console or SDK
4. Deploy your backend on Alibaba Cloud (ECS, Function Compute, or Container Service)
5. Ensure your code repository links to a file demonstrating Alibaba Cloud service usage

8 · Rules Summary & Key Restrictions

Originality	Projects must be original work. If a project existed before the hackathon, it must have been significantly updated during the Submission Period. Entrants should explain how it was updated.
IP Ownership	Submissions must be solely owned by the Entrant, with no third-party IP claims. Open-source components are allowed if licenses are complied with.
No Financial Support	Projects must not have been developed with financial or preferential support from Alibaba Cloud or Devpost prior to the hackathon.
Multiple Submissions	Entrants may submit more than one project, but each must be unique and substantially different from others.
Testing Access	Judges must be able to test the project free of charge during the Judging Period. Provide login credentials if the project is behind authentication.
Draft Submissions	You may save draft versions before the deadline. After the Submission Period closes, no changes are permitted.
Intellectual Property License	By submitting, you grant Alibaba Cloud and Devpost a non-exclusive license to use your submission for judging, evaluating, and promoting the hackathon for up to 3 years.
Taxes & Fees	Winners are responsible for all applicable taxes, currency conversion fees, and reporting requirements in their jurisdiction.
Verification	All potential winners undergo identity and eligibility verification. A prize is not confirmed until the post-competition affidavit is completed and verified.

9 · Blog Post Bonus Prize

Ten blog post prizes of \$500 cash + \$500 cloud credits are available to entrants who document their hackathon experience publicly. This is an excellent way to earn an additional \$1,000 in value for approximately 1–2 hours of writing.

Requirements

- You must be registered for the hackathon on Devpost and have submitted an eligible project.
- Write and publish a public blog post or social media post about your progress or journey building with Qwen Cloud during this hackathon.
- The content must be relevant to the hackathon and to the project you built.
- Include the blog post URL in your Devpost submission form.

Evaluation Criteria for Blog Posts

Blog submissions are evaluated based on thoroughness and potential impact. Strong posts tend to include: technical architecture explanations, challenges overcome, code snippets, architecture diagrams, lessons learned, and honest reflections on the development journey.

Recommended Platforms: Dev.to, Medium, Hashnode, Substack, LinkedIn Articles, or any publicly accessible platform. A Twitter/X thread also qualifies as a social post.

10 · Important Links & Contacts

Hackathon Website	qwencloud-hackathon.devpost.com
Qwen Cloud Sign-Up	qwencloud.com
Free Quota Dashboard	home.qwencloud.com/benefits
Qwen Cloud Privacy Policy	qwencloud.com/legal/privacy
Devpost Administrator	Devpost, Inc. — 250 Broadway, Floor 24, New York, NY 10007
Sponsor	Alibaba Cloud — 51 Bras Basah Road #03-06, Singapore 189554